

Amendment No. 1 to HB2329

White
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 2140*

House Bill No. 2329

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 3, Part 3, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) The department of education shall create and administer a statewide school nurse grant program to assist LEAs and public charter schools in employing full-time school nurses.

(b) Subject to appropriations, the department shall, upon receiving an application from an LEA or public charter school, award a school nurse grant to an LEA or public charter school for each full-time school nurse employed by the LEA or public charter school who:

(1) Is licensed by the board of nursing as a licensed practical nurse or registered nurse; and

(2) Is assigned to provide school health services to the general student population.

(c) A school nurse grant awarded pursuant to this section must only be used to cover the salary and benefits of one (1) or more full-time school nurses who meet the requirements of subsection (b).

(d) The amount of a school nurse grant awarded to an LEA or public charter school must not exceed, for each school nurse position funded through the grant, the average cost of employing a licensed practical nurse, as determined by the department of education in consultation with the department of health.

(e) In awarding grants pursuant to this section, the department of education may give priority to an LEA or public charter school that demonstrates the greatest need, including, but not limited to, high student enrollment, documented student health needs, or limited access to existing school nursing services.

(f) This section does not limit or restrict an LEA or public charter school from supplementing any grant funds received pursuant to this section with local or other available funds for purposes of hiring or retaining a school nurse.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.